

Riccardo Di Cato

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Placement Director: Prashant Bharadwaj

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Placement Coordinator: Andrew Flores

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Education

University of California San Diego

2021–present

Ph.D. in Economics (expected 2027)

Research areas: Development Economics and Political Economy

Advisors: Sara Lowes, Samuel Bazzi, Paul Niehaus, Gaurav Khanna, Craig McIntosh

University of Bologna

2018

M.Sc. in Economics, LMEC (*summa cum laude*)

University of Pavia

2016

B.A. in Economics

Job Market Paper

Seeds of Market-Based Capitalism: Christian Missionaries and China's Modernization *with Jiachen Li*

Work in Progress

Religious Broadcasting and Politics in Italy *with Mattia Albertini*

Religious Broadcasting and Belief Formation in Tanzania *with Mattia Albertini*

The Adult Film Industry and Violence Against Women *with Santiago Cantillo*

Increasing Female Employment in the Automotive Sector in India *with Garima Sharma, Anant Nyshadham, and Achyuta Adhvaryu*

Employment

National Bureau of Economic Research

2022

Research Assistant (Prof. Samuel Bazzi)

Bocconi University

2019–2021

Research Associate (Prof. Nicola Limodio and Prof. Filippo De Marco)

Harvard University

2018–2019

Senior Research Associate (Profs. N. Nunn, J. A. Robinson, S. Lowes, and J. Weigel)

Self-employment

2015–2020

Set up and managed three tourist residences in Italy

Presentations

SIOE Conference, INSEAD	2026
HHDI-NIDE Workshop, Belfast	2026
IRES Workshop	2026
ASREC Conference	2026, 2025
SOCAR Conference	2025
DevPEC Conference	2025
University of Bologna WiP Seminar	2025
Migration and Development Conference, Bologna	2024
Boston University Center for the Study of Asia	2024

Teaching Experience

University of California San Diego	2021–present
<i>Graduate:</i> Financial Accounting; Quantitative Methods II; Data Analysis and Statistical Decision-Making.	
<i>Undergraduate:</i> Microeconomics (principles and intermediate); Financial Accounting; The Indian Economy.	
Bocconi University	2020
Financial Markets and Institutions; Public Finance.	

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

Cindy Vojtech Summer Research Prize in Economics, UC San Diego (\$1,667)	2026
IHS Research & Travel Grant (\$2,500)	2026
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics (\$6,885)	2023
21st Century India Center Travel Grant, UC San Diego (\$8,500)	2023
TRELS Grant (\$1,000)	2022
Overseas Scholarship, Université de Montréal	2018
Erasmus Scholarship, Université Pierre Mendès France	2015

Referee Service

Journal of Development Economics; Economic Development and Cultural Change

Mentoring and Community Involvement

Co-founder, Undergraduate–Graduate Economic Research Lab, UC San Diego.

Co-founder and co-host, Backstory Podcast at UC San Diego.

Organizer and director, church summer camp, Omegna, Italy; college-student mentor.

Co-founder, “Yes, I Care” community-meeting project; volunteer with Suñu Diwaan, Senegal.

Additional Information

<i>Programming</i>	Stata, R, ArcGIS, $\LaTeX$, GeoODK (advanced); Python (intermediate); Matlab (basic)
<i>Languages</i>	<i>Native:</i> Italian. <i>Fluent:</i> English, French. <i>Intermediate:</i> Spanish.
<i>Citizenship</i>	Italian citizen; U.S. permanent resident
<i>Personal life</i>	Father of three children (ages 6, 3, and 1); married to a Spanish-American